



PROGRESS REPORT

China activities: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-04

Edition of 2026-09-04-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

43 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The country appears in two continental mappings of Chinese-supplied surveillance with no contract, vendor or site held. Full record The position is unchanged at both ends: the country appears in continental mappings of Chinese-supplied smart-city and surveillance systems and in a second such account, with no contract, vendor, system name or deployment site held for this country. What is dated is thinner: founding membership of a twenty-nine-country artificial-intelligence organisation headquartered in Shanghai from 16 July 2026, with no obligation, contribution or work programme stated and no instrument of accession held.	No change
Angola	A digital-health memorandum was signed in January 2026 covering 38,000 health workers and 500,000 remote consultations, and a research centre was pledged by 2027. Full record 2026-01-26 — a four-year memorandum with a Chinese vendor covers training of about 38,000 health workers, more than 500,000 remote consultations, hospital digitisation, telemedicine and health artificial intelligence. No value, milestones or domestic financing are stated, and it was signed for the health ministry by an acting department director rather than the minister. No delivery has been reported. 2025-10-06 — a research and development centre was announced after a presidential audience, targeted by 2027, with location under evaluation and investment value undefined, paired with a pledge to train 7,000 people in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies by 2027, as reported from the audience itself. Nothing has been recorded in the ten months since. The substantive Chinese engagement on this ledger is not a memorandum at all: it is the concessional loan behind the national broadband network, reported under the fibre backbone, which has no progress report on file at either end.	Advanced, on memoranda, with no delivery reported against either

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	Thirteen cooperation agreements were signed in Beijing on 1 September 2023, one of them on digital. Full record Thirteen cooperation agreements were signed at the Great Hall of the People on 1 September 2023 during President Talon's state visit, across economy, health, digital, customs, training and communication, alongside a declaration of strategic partnership. The digital agreement is named in a list and not itemised: no subject, value, implementing agency or term is on the record for it, and nothing reports what has been done under any of the thirteen.	No change, a standing position the base holds for the first time
Botswana	China's ambassador publicly offered artificial-intelligence cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training; a vendor academy runs at five universities. Full record 2026-08-25 — the ambassador publicly offered cooperation on artificial intelligence in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching it as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 training places for developing countries and application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union. It is an offer rather than an instrument: no Botswanan response, memorandum or programme is on file. The delivered engagement is educational. A vendor academy operates with five tertiary institutions, certifying in cloud, networking, data management and cybersecurity, with a competition run across five named universities in 2025-26. The source reads as vendor-supplied copy and no student numbers or funding are held. An offer of artificial-intelligence cooperation lands in a country with no artificial-intelligence policy and adoption among the lowest measured, reported above.	Advanced
Burkina Faso	A ministerial delegation was received at a Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters in August 2026 to examine audiovisual and digital broadcasting partnership. Full record 2026-08-22 — the communications minister and a delegation were received at the Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters at the chief executive's invitation, to examine partnership in audiovisual and digital broadcasting, with the exchanges going to the terms of collaboration with the national broadcaster and the national transmission company, reported the day before by a regional outlet. Nothing existed before it and no memorandum, commitment, value or timetable is stated. The substantive Chinese engagement on this ledger is older and already delivered: the concessional loan behind 650 km of backbone, 900 surveillance cameras and 300 video-surveillance sites, reported under the fibre backbone. A broadcasting partnership would put a second Chinese vendor inside the national transmission estate.	Advanced
Burundi	A framework agreement was signed whose stated object is digital transformation of the mining chain, and equipment was handed to the state news agency. Full record A satellite television project was handed over with 300 villages equipped, implementing a continental forum pledge and funded through a south-south cooperation fund — the most nearly primary record of a Chinese digital commitment to Burundi being delivered. 2026-05-28 — the ambassador visited the state news agency and handed over information technology and production equipment. Small in value, and the only Chinese digital or media-technology engagement in the window recorded by a Burundian official source. 2026-07 — a framework agreement was signed whose stated object is explicitly digital: digital transformation of the whole mining industry chain, data-driven exploration and detection technology, laboratory capacity and a digital platform connecting resources to markets. No text of any China-Burundi digital memorandum is publicly held, so the substance is known through the counterparty's own account.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	A fourth video-surveillance tranche of FCFA 39.2bn was authorised and a fibre phase of about FCFA 108.4bn was authorised for signature. Full record 2025-12-17 - a decree authorised a fourth video-surveillance loan of FCFA 39.2bn, bringing FCFA 150.8bn mobilised over eight years across three Chinese lenders; the first phase, borrowed by the defence ministry, delivered 1,500 cameras and 2,000 portable radios on accounts that disagree about amounts and dates. 2026-03-06 - a decree authorised signature of CNY 1,350,963,161, about FCFA 108.4bn, for a further 4,000 km of backbone, a national data centre and regional links to Chad, the Central African Republic and Nigeria. The loan is not confirmed signed and the executing contractor is not confirmed.	Advanced
Cape Verde	A third phase of the surveillance programme was financed by China at about EUR 9.3m, its implementation agreement signed in August 2026. Full record 2026-08 - phase three was financed at about EUR 9.3m in non-reimbursable assistance, the implementation agreement signed by the interior minister and the Chinese ambassador at the National Police Command Centre in Praia, covering command centres, data centres and wireless base stations at three towns and expanded video surveillance in Praia and Mindelo, recorded on the financier's side. No camera count, retention rule, data-protection authorisation or oversight arrangement is published for any phase. Phase two was an RMB 92.5 million grant committed in 2019 extending the network to three islands plus a further 100 poles in Praia and installing a 4G police network, with no statement of operating status since. 2026-07-29 - a vendor delegation was received by the Prime Minister and Finance Minister, the existing partnership reviewed and a new representative introduced, with no agreement, project, sum or timetable named.	Advanced
Central African Republic	A vendor set out a four-axis electronic-government programme — a data centre, five relay sites, unified telephony and a police radio network — with no contract, amount or timetable. Full record 2026-05-27 — a vendor delegation met the ministry on a package whose first axis is a national Tier III data centre; 2026-06-03 — a working meeting set four axes: the data centre, five microwave-relay sites interconnecting ministries, unified telephony and videoconferencing, and a secure police radio network. Nothing existed before it and no contract, amount or timetable is stated; the programme is documented in no appropriation. These two accounts are the only sources under this subject the base holds for the country, and the fourth axis is carried by only one of them. The data centre it proposes is the same facility three other sponsors have proposed since 2022, reported under storage, and none of them has built it.	Advanced
Chad	Two Chinese grant agreements were signed in August 2026 with no project list or digital allocation published, and a Chinese vendor is contractor for the national data centre and the backbone. Full record The grant agreements were signed on 20 August 2026; the local-currency equivalents in circulation differ between outlets on their own conversion dates, and no project list or digital allocation is published (grants, agreements, financing). The vendor has been contractor for the national data centre and the backbone with a supervising engineer, and December 2025 coverage frames it as a prospective partner when it had been the incumbent contractor for five years (contractor, finalisation). Technology and artificial-intelligence scholarships were announced at a ministerial audience with no value, selection route, timetable or host institution stated (scholarships), and a fifth-generation platform request to the same supplier has no decision, funding or delivery on record (request).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	A vendor academy opened at the university in November 2025 and a strategic memorandum was signed with the operator's parent in February 2026. Full record The standing position is delivered infrastructure: the ambassador's own speech confirms a China-financed national backbone and a fixed-mobile convergence network modernisation delivered over the prior decade, alongside the opening of a vendor training academy at the university's technology institute on 17 November 2025. 2025-11 - the ambassador and the telecommunications minister recorded continuing engagement on artificial intelligence, mobile payments and human resources, a communique of readiness rather than a signed instrument. 2026-02 - the vendor signed a strategic cooperation memorandum with the parent of the second mobile operator covering connectivity, digital finance and operations, and naming 5G, cloud and machine-learning-driven operations. The release names the group's African markets, not this country.	Advanced
Congo	A five-year private telecom network was contracted at an oil field, and satellite navigation on the ocean railway was discussed. Full record 2025-08 - a five-year contract was announced for an operator to design and deploy a private network at a Kouilou field, described as the first private network of its kind in the country. It was announced through a corporate social-media post with no separate signature or commissioning date, and no source records the network built or in service. 2026-03 - a Chinese delegation received at the launch of railway rehabilitation works discussed integrating satellite navigation and communications, with pilots proposed and welcomed, no contract, amount or timetable, and a return visit announced. The Congolese side committed only to providing a regulatory framework favourable to innovation and investment security.	Advanced
Cote d'Ivoire	Two new memoranda were signed in 2026, on smart agriculture and meteorology, alongside a decade-old network outsourcing. Full record 2026-04-30 - the vendor running the incumbent operator's network operations marked ten years, the partnership covering more than 12 subsidiaries and over 100 million customers on the operator's own figures. No contract value, term or renewal date is held. 2026-05-19 - a smart-agriculture platform received preliminary ministerial approval, and 2026-08-06 a meteorological memorandum was signed at Shanghai on six cooperation axes. Neither states a contract or a cost. The 2018 digital education loan was fully disbursed by December 2022 with a Chinese vendor contracted to the education ministry, and has had no disbursement, completion or evaluation update since.	Advanced
Djibouti	An industrial and artificial-intelligence cooperation roadmap was presented in Beijing in June 2026, with no agreement or figure. Full record 2026-06 - a roadmap was presented to Chinese counterparts and an export-import bank in Beijing, with no agreement, instrument or figure. The standing commitment is a grant for an urban security monitoring system, committed and with no implementation record held; its own title and its deal field state different amounts and the two have not been reconciled. The relationship is otherwise visible through delivery rather than instruments: the weather early-warning system in service and the compute memorandum signed in July 2026 both run through Chinese counterparties, and neither is recorded as a bilateral agreement.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
DR Congo	A US\$1.5bn Congo River fibre memorandum was signed, and a police cooperation accord names cybercrime. Full record 2026-07 - a memorandum with a Chinese supplier covers about 2,100 km, 1,700 km along the river plus nearly 400 km terrestrial, at a stated US\$1.5bn with more than US\$400m required for the first phase, with no financing close, contract or works. Both figures are company-reported. It is the country's largest single tracked non-state digital commitment, and it is a memorandum. 2026-05 - an accord signed in Beijing by the interior vice-premier and China's public-security minister gives Chinese technical assistance to the national police naming cybercrime alongside urban crime and mining fraud, with a standing joint working group. No text, value, equipment or software list, and no data-handling or oversight arrangement is held.	Advanced
Egypt	The country appears in an eleven-country mapping of Chinese-supplied smart-city surveillance with no contract or figure held. Full record A United States firm's safe-city package was recorded as adopted in the country in 2023, with Chinese supply not separately established. The country is now one of eleven where Chinese firms were found to supply smart-city surveillance equipment, and one of the states where Chinese banks financed such systems, with the New Administrative Capital listed against multiple named vendors, and named again in continental reporting. No Egyptian contract, value, camera count or command-centre detail is held. Commercially the relationship is documented: a public cloud region has operated since 2024 with data held in country, the company stating regulator certification, Tier 3 licensing and adherence to financial-regulator residency requirements, and running a Cairo summit in June 2026 aimed at financial-sector migration. It is entirely company-reported.	No change
Equatorial Guinea	A technology cooperation roadmap aims to make the country a regional technology hub, and the state operator signed a network contract with a Chinese vendor in July 2026. Full record The roadmap names institute training and a cybersecurity and artificial intelligence forum at the new capital, with no delivery, disbursement or completion figure on record (roadmap). The operator's modernisation programme covers fifth-generation networks, embedded subscriber modules, public wireless access and fibre reactivation on that contract, signed on 9 July 2026 (contract, programme); the independent press reports opaque procurement and overlapping state operators around it. The same vendor is behind the substation fibre proposal and was met by the infrastructure operator's new leadership within a fortnight of its appointment, so one supplier stands behind the network, the grid proposal and the training pipeline.	Advanced
Ethiopia	The country is a founding member of a Shanghai-based artificial intelligence body and opened vendor tracks on cloud and data centres in July 2026. Full record Ethiopia is one of 29 founding states of the organisation, announced with 5,000 Chinese-funded training places over five years and support for joint open-source model development (founding membership). The constitutive text, membership list, powers, funding, voting rules and whether the agreement binds are all unestablished. The incumbent operator opened scoping discussions with its radio-network vendor covering cloud, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, data-centre services and wallet integration, with no value or term disclosed (vendor scoping), and a separate data-centre track with a Chinese manufacturer, with no site or value stated (data-centre track). One Chinese model accounts for about 20% of chatbot use in the country, the top of its African range (model adoption).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	A digital transformation memorandum signed in December 2025 is in force on three pillars, and a skills accord followed in July 2026. Full record An exploratory ministerial mission to the supplier's sites in June 2025 produced no agreement (exploration); the memorandum was signed on 23 December 2025 on a joint project committee, integration of Gabonese start-ups and skills transfer, with the connected-schools programme to expand from 2026 (memorandum). The skills accord of 14 July 2026 has the supplier create smart rooms, run training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and give access to its certifying kits, with no room count, trainee target, cost or duration published (skills accord, programme launch); curriculum, certificate and equipment all belong to one vendor. A smart-cities memorandum recorded for 2024 remains at pipeline status with at least US\$234m pledged and nothing drawn, the single largest line in the country's finance aggregate and reaching the base through two secondary hops (smart cities).	Advanced
Guinea	Huawei raised the backbone's first loop from 200 to 400 Gb/s on 20 May 2026 and is in talks toward a comprehensive memorandum. Full record The backbone operator SOGEB announced on 20 May 2026 that the first loop of the national fibre backbone had gone from 200 Gb/s to 400 Gb/s with Huawei's technical support, the second upgrade in eighteen months after December 2024's step from 50 Gb/s, with 600 Gb/s across the whole infrastructure targeted by year end. Huawei designed and built the roughly 4,300 to 4,500 km backbone and remains its technical partner on capacity. Talks in China on 3 July 2026 between the communication and digital economy minister and a Huawei vice-president covered network expansion, a national data centre, a sovereign cloud, rural connectivity, AI solutions, digital public services, intelligent monitoring, digital skills and technology centres, and are stated to be heading for a comprehensive memorandum and a framework agreement on priority projects. No memorandum or framework agreement is signed, and no contract value for any of it is held.	Advanced
Kenya	Two delegations were received in eight days on broadband, smart cities and technology investment, with nothing signed, valued or scheduled. Full record The second was a provincial service centre's delegation on investment, connectivity and innovation partnerships, a week after a network group's visit; two courtesy calls in eight days is a pattern of approach and not an investment (talks, first visit). A vendor states student training under way and an East Africa research and development centre planned, framed by the ministry around all-optical networks and sixth-generation readiness; the account is a vendor event and a ministry statement at it, with no contract, value or date stated (vendor). An electronic-commerce cooperation memorandum is cited as the basis for dispatching eighteen officers to a Chinese province for a trade matching activity, its signature date, terms and text not held (memorandum).	Advanced
Lesotho	Chinese engagement on file is a single financial route: renminbi settlement reaching the country through a commercial bank in July 2026. Full record Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access). No Chinese vendor contract, memorandum, loan or infrastructure project is recorded for the country in this base, which makes the payment route the whole of the relationship on record.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Libya	Chinese engagement covers a ZTE modernisation framework, Huawei's return after a three-day suspension, and reported accession to China's payment network. Full record LTT signed a memorandum with ZTE at Mobile World Congress on 9 March 2026 covering 4G and 5G, e-wallet, e-commerce, content delivery and terminals, with no value or timetable (memorandum). Huawei was suspended nationwide by the regulator on 17 August 2025 and reinstated three days later on a compliance undertaking (reinstatement). Libyan banks are reported set to join China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System, with yuan-denominated panda bonds also raised, on a single newspaper account (account).	Advanced
Madagascar	A telecommunications modernisation loan of RMB 337.9m sits behind the network, and the cabinet approved accession to a China-initiated cybercrime network in August 2026. Full record The concessional loan of RMB 337.9m, about US\$54,708,617 at the capture conversion, was committed in 2020 with no implementation record held (loan, project). Accession to the cybercrime network was approved on 4 August 2026, mobilising five ministries and the gendarmerie for cross-border cooperation on online fraud (accession). Those two instruments, a decade apart in kind, are the whole of the recorded relationship: no vendor contract, data centre or technology framework is separately held.	Advanced
Malawi	Two concessional loans financed the fibre backbone, the defence force intends to learn military artificial intelligence from China, and the country rejected a safe-city surveillance package. Full record The backbone's second phase was financed at CNY 693,000,000 over twenty years, on-lent to the electricity utility with first repayment falling due in March 2027 (loan, first phase). The defence relationship is stated to extend past exchanges into specialised training, equipment supply and institutional development, with command-level training under discussion (defence). Malawi is the only one of five countries studied to have rejected the safe-city surveillance package offered by Chinese companies, and the base holds no account of who rejected it, when, or on what grounds (rejection).	Mixed, concessional fibre lending and a defence artificial-intelligence relationship against a rejected surveillance package
Mali	A Chinese supplier replaced a French one on the national biometric passport in October 2025, a change officials cast as regained sovereignty. Full record The passport supplier changed from Idemia of France to Emptech of China, with officials framing it as regained sovereignty and local data management (supplier). No contract value, term or data-hosting arrangement is published. It is the only Chinese engagement on record for the country, and it sits at the most sensitive point in the identity stack.	Advanced
Mauritania	A Chinese government grant of MUR 629.4m funded an urban security system, with no delivery, siting or oversight arrangement on record. Full record The grant was recorded in 2021 through a bilateral cooperation agreement (grant). Five years on, no delivery, siting or oversight arrangement for the system is on record. A surveillance deployment funded by a foreign state with no published oversight is the kind of thing a data-protection authority would be expected to have ruled on, and no decision of the authority is held on anything.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	A preferential buyers credit of US\$73.7m is the largest external digital-sector financing on the country's record, with no repayment or completion statement published. Full record The credit is recorded in the finance ministry's own annual report (credit). Eight years on, no repayment, drawdown or completion statement has been published, and no other Chinese instrument, vendor contract or cooperation framework is recorded for the country.	No change
Morocco	The only Chinese engagement on file is a vendor dual-band radio deployment on rail and motorway corridors, in commercial service in 2026. Full record An operator and a Chinese vendor put the first commercial deployment of a 1.8 GHz and 2.1 GHz configuration into service on rail and motorway corridors, claiming a 13 dB coverage gain, 83 per cent higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users with no additional sites built (deployment, partnership). Every performance figure is the operator's and the vendor's own and is unverified. No Chinese state instrument, loan or technology cooperation framework for the country is held.	Advanced
Mozambique	Chinese engagement runs to a US\$132m network facility, local cloud services billed in local currency, and city surveillance cameras reported concentrated in opposition areas. Full record The network modernisation facility was committed in 2020 with no signed loan agreement public (facility). Local cloud services launched in Maputo billed in local currency in 2024, and nothing on the deployment has entered the base since (cloud). A research report of March 2026 records cameras from three Chinese suppliers concentrated in political-opposition areas in the absence of adequate legal regulation or oversight; it is researcher-reported, and no contract, financier, deployment date, supplier split or camera count for the country is held (surveillance).	Advanced
Namibia	China committed CNY 98,000,000 to the capital smart-city pilot, is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads and handed over the country's first satellite ground station. Full record The commitment, about US\$14.4m on the source's conversion, covers digital infrastructure, artificial-intelligence capability and skills under the city's ten-year strategy (commitment); the signature date is padded from a reference to the end of June, and an opposition member gives the same commitment as N\$245m (commitment, talks, record). A vendor is building smart-city solutions and a data centre with two ministries, with no signed agreement, annexure or contractor list held (data centre). The satellite ground station outside the capital was handed over by China and is operated by fourteen trained Namibians (station). An opposition member has raised data-control concerns about the smart-city grant.	Advanced
Niger	A 2014 concessional loan built the 2,275 km domestic backbone completed in 2017, and no post-2017 Chinese financing or vendor contract is on record. Full record The vendor has operated in the country since 1998 and China's newly arrived ambassador met its vice-president in September 2025 to discuss deepening cooperation (meeting). The 2014 loan of RMB 623.7m financed the domestic backbone (loan, record), and no financing or contract since 2017 is held. Diplomatic relations trace to 1974 and the 2023 change of government has not disrupted them on the embassy's account.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A vendor innovation centre was framed by the minister as a catalyst for technology sovereignty, a vendor academy sits inside the teacher-training accreditor, and an agentic AI cloud launched locally in August 2026. Full record The Lagos innovation centre opened in May 2025 and was framed by the minister as a catalyst for the country's technology sovereignty, an unusually sovereignty-coded reception for a Chinese vendor (centre). The academy sits at the commission itself and runs continuous training for lecturers and students, with the college curriculum revised to add artificial intelligence and robotics, networking and cybersecurity, data science and software development; no term, value or deliverable is published, so a single vendor's certification track is being written into the qualification route for the teachers who will go on to teach it (academy). 2026-08-27 — the vendor launched an agentic artificial-intelligence cloud on its local infrastructure at its own Lagos summit, offered with data residency, security, compliance and low-latency claims for finance, telecommunications, internet services, government and enterprise. The technology development agency framed it against the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative and its ambition to move the country from consuming technology to hosting it — sovereignty language again attached to a foreign vendor's platform. No customer, contract, capacity or price is stated, and the residency claims are the vendor's own.	Advanced
Rwanda	No bilateral technology instrument with China is held, and the record is an exploratory ambassadorial meeting in January 2026. Full record The meeting was exploratory and no instrument came out of it that the base holds (meeting). Surveillance supply is asserted only at continent level with no national contract named, which is worth stating plainly: the base has no evidence of Chinese technology procurement by this government at any date.	No change
Senegal	A strategic partnership with a Chinese vendor took artificial-intelligence-in-education governance to Beijing in August 2026, and thirteen months on the base holds no evidence the assembly plant exists. Full record The partnership was signed a month before the window opened, so it is the baseline rather than news, and thirteen months on nothing establishes that the assembly plant it named exists (partnership, accord, sovereignty). A position on media technology cooperation was put at a Sino-African media forum in August 2026, with no instrument, funding or work programme named (media). The sovereign cloud recorded elsewhere in this report is the one Chinese arrangement that has produced installed equipment, and its contract, value and data-access terms are unpublished.	Advanced
Seychelles	A Chinese vendor supplies the incumbent fifth-generation core and, with the education ministry, the smart education programme across four schools. Full record The vendor supplied the incumbent's fifth-generation launch in 2020 and the school programme in August 2025 (core, schools). A second Chinese supplier holds the stalled emergency-communications memorandum with the same incumbent, unmoved in more than seventeen months. So Chinese vendors supply the mobile core, a school technology programme and a proposed emergency-communications core, and no procurement terms, security review or exit arrangement is published for any of them.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Somalia	A satellite imagery memorandum was signed in April 2026, the first digital instrument under a partnership reaffirmed in January. Full record The two foreign ministers reaffirmed the strategic partnership, elevated in September 2024, in a January 2026 call, agreeing to deepen trade, development assistance and multilateral cooperation (statement). Nothing in it names digital infrastructure. In April the space and satellite department signed a memorandum with China's land satellite remote-sensing centre covering satellite-imagery application, technical cooperation and knowledge exchange (memorandum). That is the first Chinese digital instrument the base holds. It carries no value and no delivery date.	Advanced
South Africa	A domestic bank went live on China's cross-border payment system and was jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa; a disability-data plan was agreed. Full record 2025-11-20 — a domestic bank went live as the first African direct participant in China's cross-border interbank payment system, inaugurated at the central bank with both countries' central bank governors present. 2026-06-26 — the same bank and a Chinese state bank were jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa, covering the nineteen African countries where the group operates. The designation was made by one foreign central bank with no African regulator party to it. 2026-08-12 — outside payments, a seven-point plan on disability-inclusive data, universal design and assistive technology was agreed, naming the national statistics office as a partner with no instrument or data-sharing arrangement published. The engagement is deepest where it is least visible as policy: the payments arrangements are commercial acts by a listed bank, authorised abroad, and no domestic instrument records or governs them.	Advanced
South Sudan	A Chinese vendor re-engaged after a rift dating from 2014, and exploratory talks were held in Hangzhou in August 2026 with nothing contracted. Full record The re-engagement was reported in February 2026, following stated interest in the country's digital future the previous September (re-engagement, interest). No contract, memorandum or workstream is named. The largest single commitment on this ledger is a Chinese loan for an air traffic management system, dated only to its year, so the relationship is substantial and almost entirely undocumented here. 2026-08-31 — the ICT minister held exploratory talks with a vendor vice-president in Hangzhou, on the sidelines of a China-Africa digital conference, and said the government is ready to seek the vendor's expertise in connecting public services. Participation is sought in smart cities, energy solutions and a national data hub in Juba, and the 2014 rift followed government accusations of hacked official email and forged documents, through which the vendor stayed in the market. Still no agreement, contract or figure.	Advanced
Sudan	The digital transformation and communications minister attended the opening of a digital cooperation centre with China (report). Full record The digital transformation and communications minister attended the opening of a digital cooperation centre with China (report). No instrument, value or scope is stated. China's foreign ministry separately records a strategic partnership dating from September 2015 and states that its cooperation projects in Sudan have been suspended since April 2023 (profile).	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	A banking partnership covering eight areas was signed in Shanghai, and an artificial-intelligence skills memorandum carries jobs and economy figures that are the partner chairman's projections. Full record The banking agreement is company-reported with no contract value, duration or delivery milestone published (banking). The skills memorandum was signed with a United Nations health industry foundation and a private foundation; the 50,000 jobs and the 2040 economy figure are the partner chairman's projections, not commitments (skills). The country's own open-source language model is separately reported as built on a Chinese open-weight base, which is the substantive dependency rather than either memorandum.	Advanced
Zambia	A bilateral seminar set out sovereignty conditions for digital cooperation with no agreement signed, against Chinese financing of the national data centre, the backbone and the towers programme. Full record Sovereignty conditions were set out at the seminar and no agreement was signed; the source body is an excerpt rather than a full capture (seminar, ties, support). The existing relationship is not a matter of intention: Chinese concessional finance built the national data centre, funded the towers programme to the disbursement level recorded elsewhere in this report and left the backbone extension wholly undrawn, and the same vendor holds the artificial-intelligence data centre memorandum. Setting conditions on future cooperation while the installed base is already Chinese-financed is the position the record supports.	Advanced
Zimbabwe	The national data centre was launched in February 2021 under a US\$98m broadband initiative, vendor-led and export-credit financed, and city surveillance systems are mapped here with no domestic contract value or camera count held. Full record The data centre's date and figure come from a peer-reviewed article rather than a government statement (centre). The surveillance mapping covers eleven countries and no domestic contract value or camera count is held (surveillance, smart city). An export credit facility of CNY 485,000,000 for mobile network expansion was committed in 2019 with a dollar equivalent carrying no conversion date (credit), and a forum in August 2026 discussed technology transfer critically, naming no project, transfer arrangement or commitment (forum).	No change

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.